

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Geometry and Trigonometry	Circles	Hard

Question

A circle has center O , and points A and B lie on the circle. The measure of arc AB is 45° and the length of arc AB is 3 inches. What is the circumference, in inches, of the circle?

Answer

- A. 3
- B. 6
- C. 9
- D. 24

Correct Answer: D

Rationale

Choice D is correct. It's given that the measure of arc AB is 45° and the length of arc AB is 3 inches. The arc measure of the full circle is 360° . If x represents the circumference, in inches, of the circle, it follows that $\frac{45^\circ}{360^\circ} = \frac{3 \text{ inches}}{x \text{ inches}}$. This equation is equivalent to $\frac{45}{360} = \frac{3}{x}$, or $\frac{1}{8} = \frac{3}{x}$. Multiplying both sides of this equation by $8x$ yields $1(x) = 3(8)$, or $x = 24$. Therefore, the circumference of the circle is 24 inches.

Choice A is incorrect. This is the length of arc AB .

Choice B is incorrect and may result from multiplying the length of arc AB by 2 .

Choice C is incorrect and may result from squaring the length of arc AB .